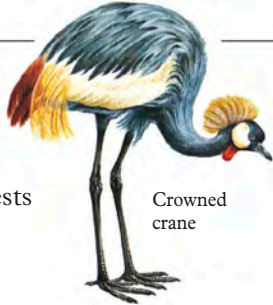


GRASSLANDS



Grass grows in the vast spaces between wet forests and dry deserts. These rolling seas of grass have several names: the tropical African plains are known as savanna, while the colder grasslands are called prairies, pampas, or steppes. These green lands are important to people because they make good farmland. To birds, they are a perfect place to live. There are tall grasses to hide in, and seeds, grasshoppers, beetles, and worms just waiting to be eaten.



Crowned crane

Two for dinner

Honeyguides love beeswax but they can't open a bees' nest. They have to find a big-clawed badger to rip open the nest for them.



The honeyguide leads the way.



The badger leaves plenty for the patient bird.



Bees



If an oxpecker sees a lion, it calls very loudly and warns the buffalo of danger.

Oxpeckers have strong, sharp claws for clinging to thick skin.

Doctor oxpecker!

Oxpeckers peck bloodsucking pests, called ticks, out of the skin of buffalo and zebras. This "surgery" helps to keep the animals healthy.

The buffalo ignores the oxpecker, unless it pecks inside its ears!

Oxpeckers are about 5 inches (12 cm) tall and live in Africa.

